HS1102 MEDIA PROJECT

EXERCISE 6 (Part B) — Story Selection (Team Submission)

AY 2026–27

Team Number: 518

STORY ANCHOR NAME & ROLL NUMBER: Melvin John (SE26UCSE098)

Team Member 2 Name & Roll No.: Yedlapalli Jayendra Pallav (SE26UCSE178)

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EXERCISE DETAILS

Exercise Number: 6 (Part B)

Submission Date: 16/10/26

Between Their Eyes and Mine

Saf had become very good at checking people before she let herself like them. Every evening, she scrolled through profiles and messages, wondering whether her mother would approve, whether their families would get along, and whether cultural differences would eventually become a problem. After her previous relationship ended badly, partly because of her mother's judgment, Saf had learned to associate love with scrutiny. The protagonist believes that she must earn her family's approval before she can trust her own feelings. She wants a partner her family will accept, but what she needs is someone around whom she can be herself without fear of judgment.

Her routine changes when her friend Mira tells her that a guy Saf met at an inter-college event wants to meet her. Saf remembers how naturally they had spoken and how she hadn't felt the need to filter herself around him. For a moment, she is excited. Then she discovers that his cultural background differs from hers, and her mother's imagined questions return. Afraid of repeating her previous experience, Saf refuses the opportunity, convincing herself that avoiding attachment is safer than risking disapproval.

Mira visits her and asks what Saf actually wants, rather than what everyone else might think. She reminds Saf how comfortable and genuine she had seemed around him. Saf has no immediate answer, but the question stays with her. Eventually, she messages him and agrees to meet. Leaving home for their first meeting becomes her first real commitment to choosing something for herself, even without knowing how her family will react.

Their conversations gradually become a space where Saf can be herself. They meet after classes, share music and stories, and laugh without her constantly second-guessing every word. Mira supports her, while a classmate's remarks about their cultural differences reveal how easily outside judgment can revive Saf's insecurities. Still, Saf begins believing she can maintain the relationship while eventually finding a way to secure her family's approval.

That confidence collapses when her mother discovers a photograph of Saf and him together. Her mother questions his background and warns Saf against repeating the mistakes of her previous relationship. Saf tries explaining that he treats her well, but the conversation returns to cultural differences and her mother's fears. Overwhelmed, Saf retreats to her room and opens their chat, preparing to end things before the situation becomes more painful. She nearly sends the message, believing that giving him up will restore peace.

Then Saf recognises the pattern. She has been trying so hard to prevent rejection that she is rejecting her own feelings first. She deletes the message and meets him to explain what

happened. He listens without demanding that she choose between him and her family. Saf realises that she cannot control everyone's opinions, but she can choose to be honest about her own. Her reward is not certainty or approval; it is the first genuine trust in her own judgment.

The conflict does not disappear. Her mother remains concerned, and Saf knows that keeping the relationship may bring further arguments. This time, however, she refuses to return to secrecy or abandon him simply to avoid discomfort. When her mother questions her again, Saf acknowledges her concerns without pretending that her own feelings do not matter. She explains that she wants her family to understand her choice, but she cannot promise to stop caring about someone merely because their backgrounds differ.

Saf's response marks a change from the girl who once measured every possibility against imagined disapproval. She still fears disappointing her family, and she does not know whether they will eventually accept him. What she no longer believes is that avoiding conflict is worth abandoning herself. She carries this understanding into her ordinary life, learning to make room for both her family's importance and her own emotional independence. The cost is uncertainty, but the reward is the possibility of being loved without pretending to be someone else.

Story Selection Report

Typed, one A4 page, one report per team. Replace the grey prompts with your text and keep the page to one A4. Submit it in a single PDF with your Full Story and the front page template. Deadline: 16 October.

Team number		**Section / Story Anchor**	

No.	Team member	Roll number	Blueprint submitted (protagonist)
1	*Melvin John*	*SE26UCSE098*	*Saf*
2	*Yedlapalli Jayendra Pallav*	*SE26UCSE178*	*Cole*
3	*Rudr Mansukhani*	*SE26UCSE131*	*Mira*
4	*Brundavan Ram Manohar*	*SE26UCSE188*	*Sora and Shiro*

1 The decision

❌ Selected wholesale: the blueprint by [member name]

✅ Synthesised: elements combined from the members credited in Section 3

Working title of the selected story: ***Between Their Eyes and Mine***

The flaw, in one sentence: The protagonist no longer believes that avoiding conflict is worth abandoning herself.

2 Rationale against the four criteria *Aim for two or three sentences each, citing specific moments.*

A. Strength and specificity of the flaw *A false belief, not a trait; the engine of the story?*	*Saf's flaw is her belief that she must earn her family's approval before trusting her own feelings. This drives the story when she initially refuses to meet him because of their cultural differences and later considers ending the relationship after her mother questions her choice.*
B. Visual potential *Concrete, drawable moments, not abstract interior states?*	*The story has several moments that can be communicated visually, including Saf hesitating over her phone, the photograph of her with him being discovered by her mother, and the two photographs on the cover representing her relationship and her family. The contrast between the coloured photographs and the monochrome background visually reflects the conflict between her personal feelings and outside expectations.*
C. Originality and creative risk *A genuine risk in protagonist, ending, structure or world?*	*Instead of presenting the family as villains or making Saf reject them completely, the story explores the more complicated conflict between respecting family opinions and making independent choices. The ending does not guarantee that her family will approve, allowing Saf's growth to come from trusting herself despite uncertainty.*

D. Completeness and internal coherence *Does the twelve-stage arc hold together, with a clear centre of gravity?*	*All twelve stages of the Hero's Journey connect through Saf's struggle with approval-seeking, from refusing the initial opportunity to confronting her mother's disapproval. The Ordeal occurs when Saf nearly ends the relationship to avoid conflict, while the Resurrection is shown when she chooses honesty and stands by her feelings without abandoning her family.*

3 Credit attribution

If one blueprint was chosen wholesale, credit its author in every row.

Story element	Contributed by	What exactly was taken or adapted
Protagonist and flaw	*Melvin*	*Saf's approval-seeking flaw, her fear of family disapproval, and her need to trust her own judgment.*
World and setting	*Melvin*	*The everyday university setting, her friendship with Mira, and the cultural expectations surrounding relationships.*
Ordeal and Resurrection	*Melvin*	*The mother's disapproval, Saf nearly ending the relationship, and her decision to be honest rather than reject her own feelings.*
Ending	*Melvin*	*Saf accepting uncertainty and choosing to trust herself without completely rejecting her family.*
Other (motif, structure, image)	*Jayendra, Rudr, Ram*	*Color Palette*

Credit every contributing member accurately: this carries forward to the Story Origins page of your final book.